

Salary 2045

Installation Guide

For people who have never used a terminal before

This guide walks you through every single click and keystroke, with real screenshots at each step.

Windows only. Mac users: steps are almost identical — use Terminal instead of cmd.

What you will need:

- A computer running Windows
- An internet connection
- About 10 minutes
- No prior experience required

Steps overview:

Step 1 — Install Python

Step 2 — Download the app from GitHub

Step 3 — Open a terminal window inside the app folder

Step 4 — Install required libraries

Step 5 — Enter your stock holdings

Step 6 — (Optional) Add an Alpha Vantage API key

Step 7 — (Optional) Set your income goal

Step 8 — Run the app

Step 1

Install Python

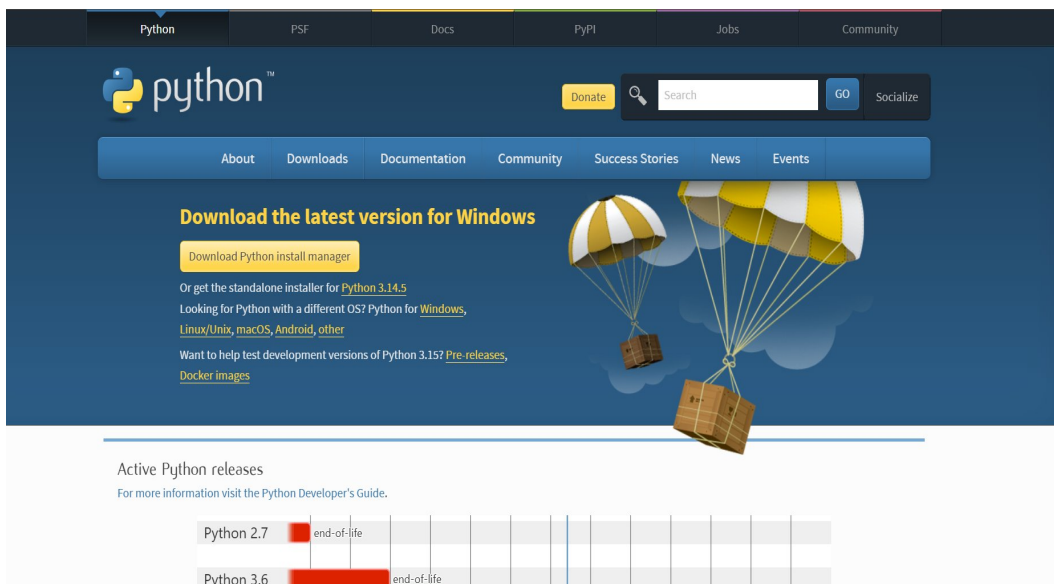
Python is the engine that makes the app run. You only do this once.

What is Python?

Python is a free program that lets your computer run apps like this one. You don't need to understand it — just install it.

1. Open your web browser and go to:

`python.org/downloads`



↑ The Python downloads page — click the yellow button

2. Click the yellow button that says Download Python.
3. A file will download. Find it in your Downloads folder and double-click it.

■ **CRITICAL** — do not miss this step:

On the very first screen of the installer, at the bottom, there is a small checkbox:

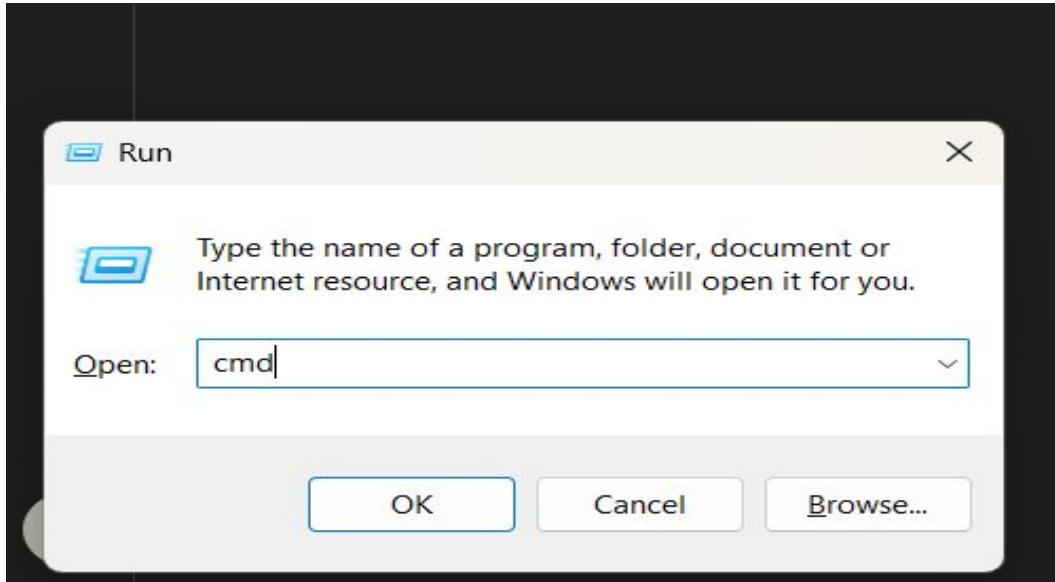
"Add Python to PATH"

You **MUST** tick that box before clicking Install Now. If you skip it, the app will not run.

4. Click Install Now and wait 1-2 minutes for it to finish.

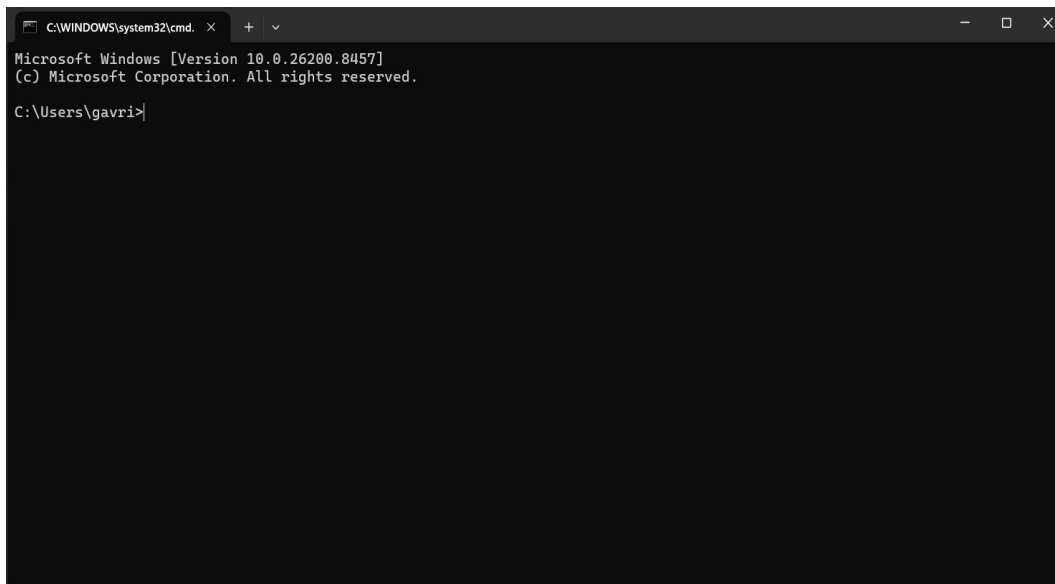
How to check that Python was installed correctly:

1. Hold the Windows key and press R at the same time. A small box appears.
2. Type cmd and click OK.



↑ Type cmd in the Run box and click OK

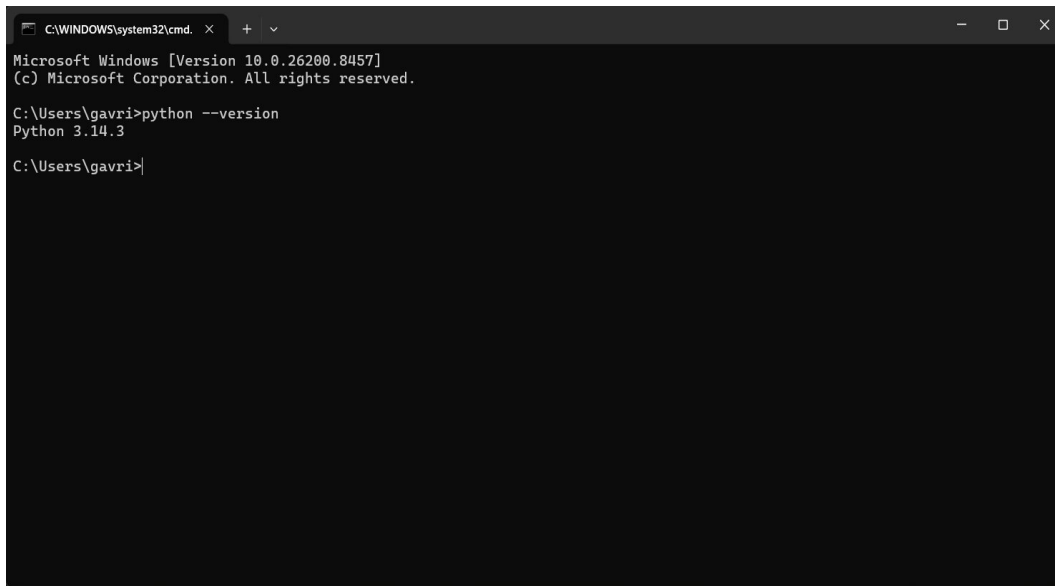
3. A black window opens. This is the terminal.



↑ The terminal — a black window where you type commands

4. Type the following and press Enter:

```
python --version
```



```
C:\WINDOWS\system32\cmd. X + v
Microsoft Windows [Version 10.0.26200.8457]
(c) Microsoft Corporation. All rights reserved.

C:\Users\gavri>python --version
Python 3.14.3

C:\Users\gavri>
```

↑ If you see Python 3.x.x — Python is installed correctly

✓ If you see Python 3.x.x — Python is installed. Move on to Step 2.

■ If you see 'python is not recognized' — uninstall Python via Start → Add or remove programs, reinstall it, and this time tick the Add Python to PATH checkbox.

Step 2

Download the App

No GitHub account needed. Just download a ZIP file.

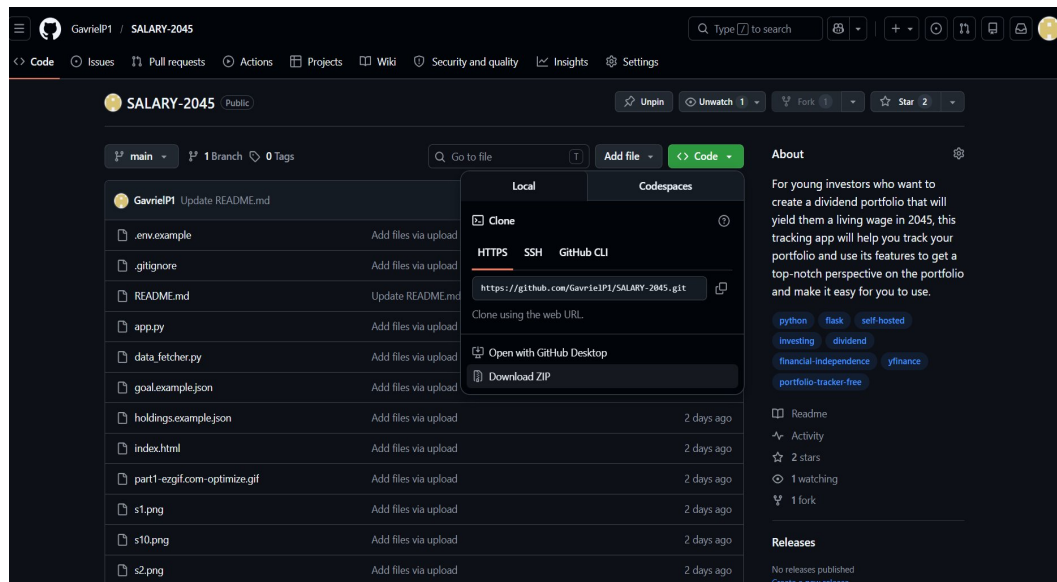
GitHub is a website where developers share code. You are just downloading a ZIP file — exactly like downloading any file from the internet.

1. Open your browser and go to:

```
github.com/GavrielP1/SALARY-2045
```

2. Click the green button that says Code.

3. A small menu appears. Click Download ZIP.



↑ Click the green Code button, then Download ZIP

4. A ZIP file downloads to your Downloads folder.

How to extract (unzip) it:

1. Open your Downloads folder.

2. Right-click the ZIP file → Extract All...

3. Choose a location (Desktop is fine) → click Extract.

✓ A folder named SALARY-2045-main will appear. You can rename it to anything you like.

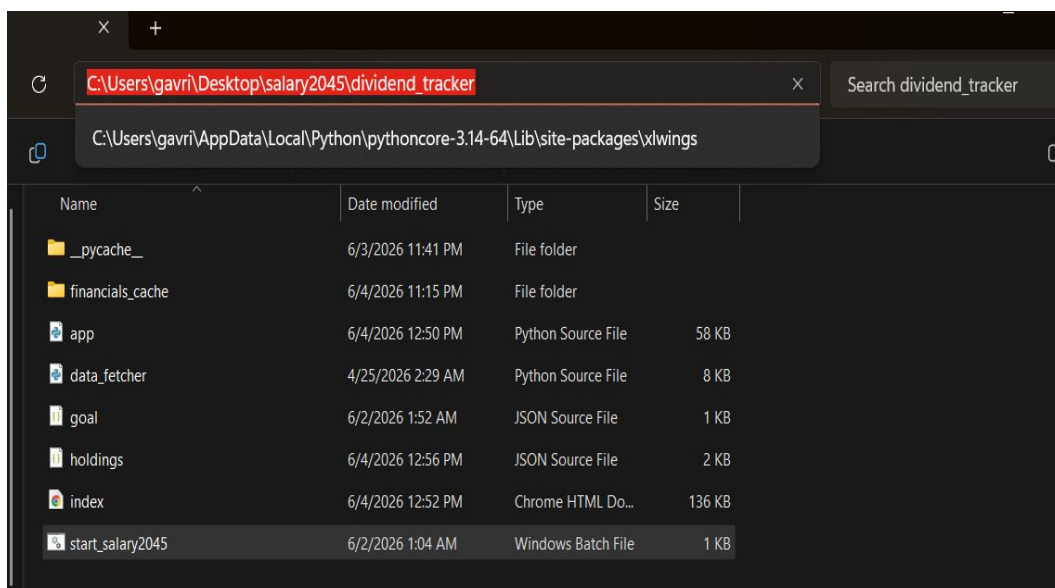
Step 3

Open the Terminal Inside the App Folder

The terminal needs to be opened inside the correct folder.

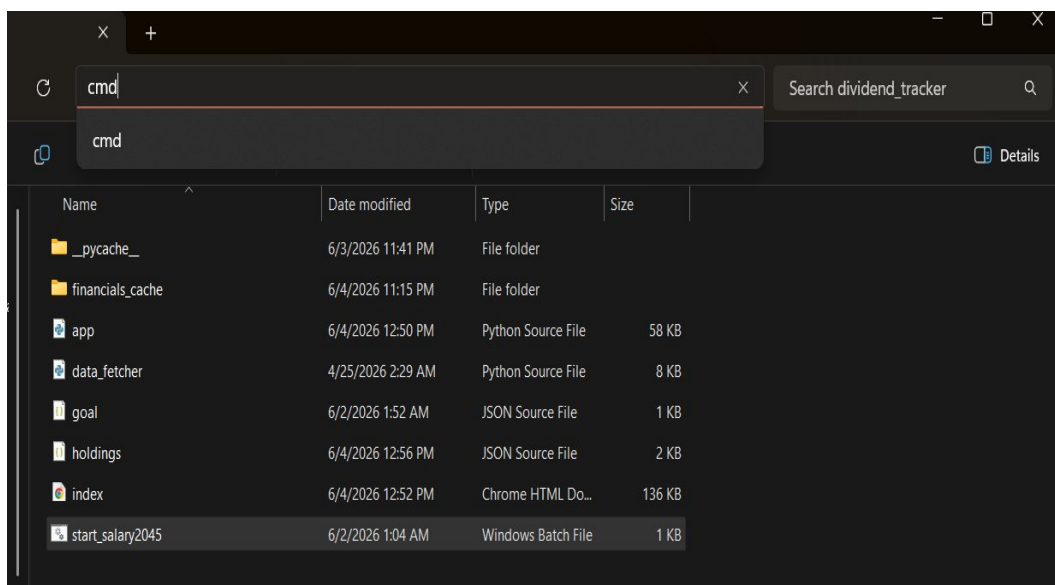
The terminal works like a compass — it needs to know where it is. If you open it in the wrong folder, the commands won't find the app files.

1. Open the app folder in File Explorer.
2. Click once on the address bar at the top — the path will become highlighted.



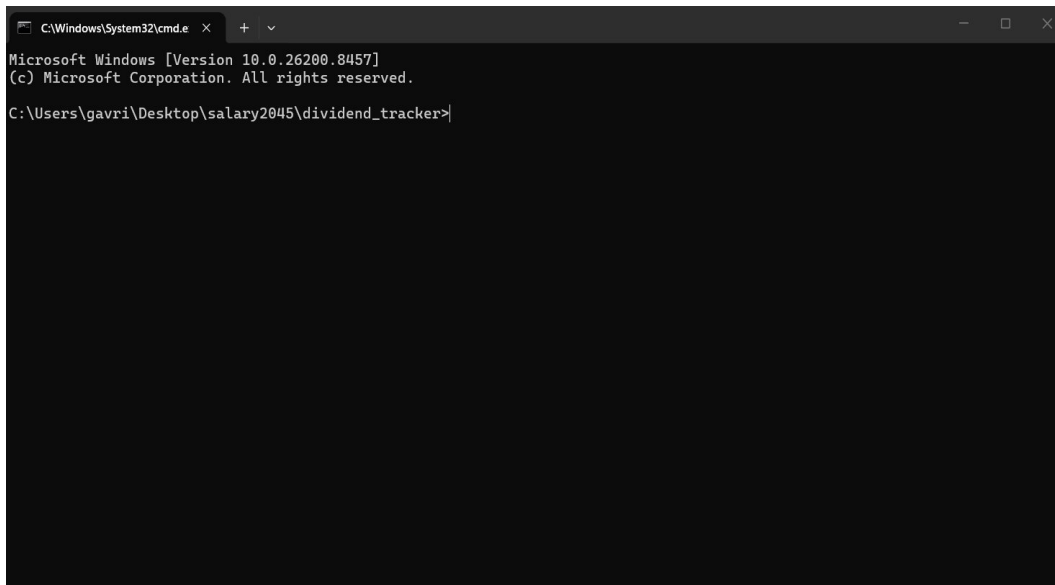
↑ Click the address bar so the path gets highlighted like this

3. Type `cmd` (this replaces the highlighted text) and press Enter.



↑ Type cmd and press Enter

4. A black terminal window opens. The line inside should end with your folder name.

A screenshot of a Windows Command Prompt window. The title bar shows 'C:\Windows\System32\cmd.exe'. The window content displays the following text: 'Microsoft Windows [Version 10.0.26280.8457]', '(c) Microsoft Corporation. All rights reserved.', and 'C:\Users\gavri\Desktop\salary2045\dividend_tracker>'. The cursor is at the end of the path.

↑ The terminal is now open inside your app folder — you can see the folder path

✓ If you see your folder name at the end of the line — you are in the right place.

■ If the path looks wrong — close the window and try again from step 1.

Step 4

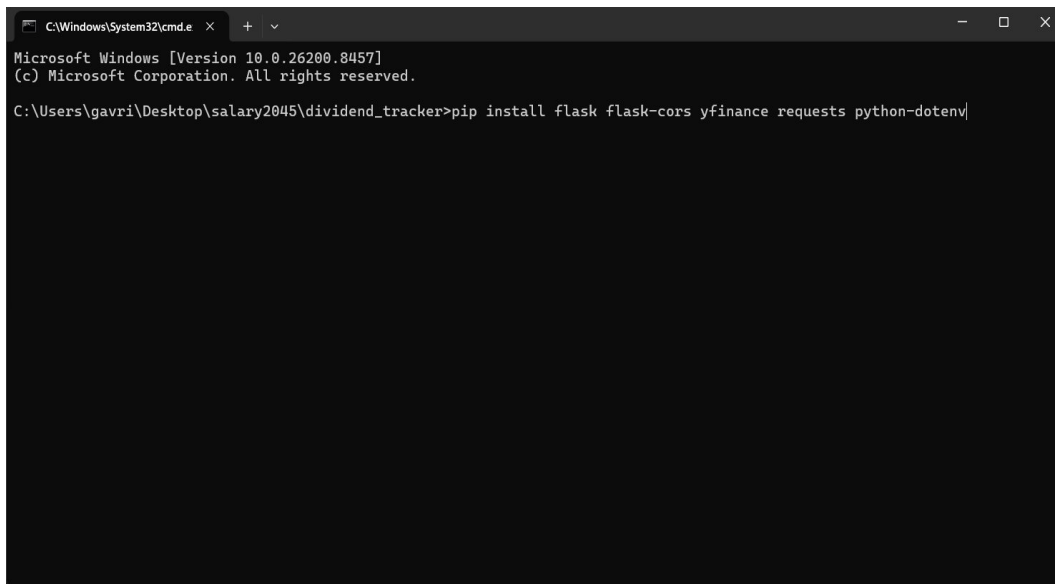
Install the Required Libraries

One command. Takes 1-2 minutes. Only done once.

Libraries are free pieces of code the app depends on. This step downloads and installs them.

1. Click inside the terminal window.
2. Type the following command exactly and press Enter:

```
pip install flask flask-cors yfinance requests python-dotenv
```



↑ Type the pip install command and press Enter

A lot of text will scroll down the screen — this is normal. Wait for it to finish.


```
C:\Windows\System32\cmd.e x + v
ges (from yfinance) (16.0)
Requirement already satisfied: cffi>=1.12.0 in c:\users\gavri\appdata\local\python\pythoncore-3.14-64\lib\site-packages
(from curl_cffi<0.14,>=0.7->yfinance) (2.0.0)
Requirement already satisfied: certifi>=2024.2.2 in c:\users\gavri\appdata\local\python\pythoncore-3.14-64\lib\site-pack
ages (from curl_cffi<0.14,>=0.7->yfinance) (2026.2.25)
Requirement already satisfied: charset-normalizer<4,>=2 in c:\users\gavri\appdata\local\python\pythoncore-3.14-64\lib\si
te-packages (from requests) (3.4.6)
Requirement already satisfied: idna<4,>=2.5 in c:\users\gavri\appdata\local\python\pythoncore-3.14-64\lib\site-packages
(from requests) (3.11)
Requirement already satisfied: urllib3<3,>=1.26 in c:\users\gavri\appdata\local\python\pythoncore-3.14-64\lib\site-packa
ges (from requests) (2.6.3)
Requirement already satisfied: soupsieve>=1.6.1 in c:\users\gavri\appdata\local\python\pythoncore-3.14-64\lib\site-packa
ges (from BeautifulSoup4>=4.11.1->yfinance) (2.8.3)
Requirement already satisfied: typing-extensions>=4.0.0 in c:\users\gavri\appdata\local\python\pythoncore-3.14-64\lib\si
te-packages (from BeautifulSoup4>=4.11.1->yfinance) (4.15.0)
Requirement already satisfied: pycparser in c:\users\gavri\appdata\local\python\pythoncore-3.14-64\lib\site-packages (fr
om cffi>=1.12.0->curl_cffi<0.14,>=0.7->yfinance) (3.0)
Requirement already satisfied: colorama in c:\users\gavri\appdata\local\python\pythoncore-3.14-64\lib\site-packages (fro
m click>=8.1.3->flask) (0.4.6)
Requirement already satisfied: python-dateutil>=2.8.2 in c:\users\gavri\appdata\local\python\pythoncore-3.14-64\lib\site
-packages (from pandas>=1.3.0->yfinance) (2.9.0.post0)
Requirement already satisfied: tzdata in c:\users\gavri\appdata\local\python\pythoncore-3.14-64\lib\site-packages (from
pandas>=1.3.0->yfinance) (2025.3)
Requirement already satisfied: six>=1.5 in c:\users\gavri\appdata\local\python\pythoncore-3.14-64\lib\site-packages (fro
m python-dateutil>=2.8.2->pandas>=1.3.0->yfinance) (1.17.0)

[notice] A new release of pip is available: 25.3 -> 26.1.2
[notice] To update, run: C:\Users\gavri\AppData\Local\Python\pythoncore-3.14-64\python.exe -m pip install --upgrade pip

C:\Users\gavri\Desktop\salary2045\dividend_tracker>
```

↑ When it finishes, you will see the folder path again at the bottom

✓ When you see the folder path line again at the bottom — it is done.

Note: You may see a yellow or orange [notice] message about a pip update. This is NOT an error — ignore it.

■ If you see 'pip is not recognized' — reinstall Python and tick the Add Python to PATH checkbox.

Step 5

Enter Your Stock Holdings

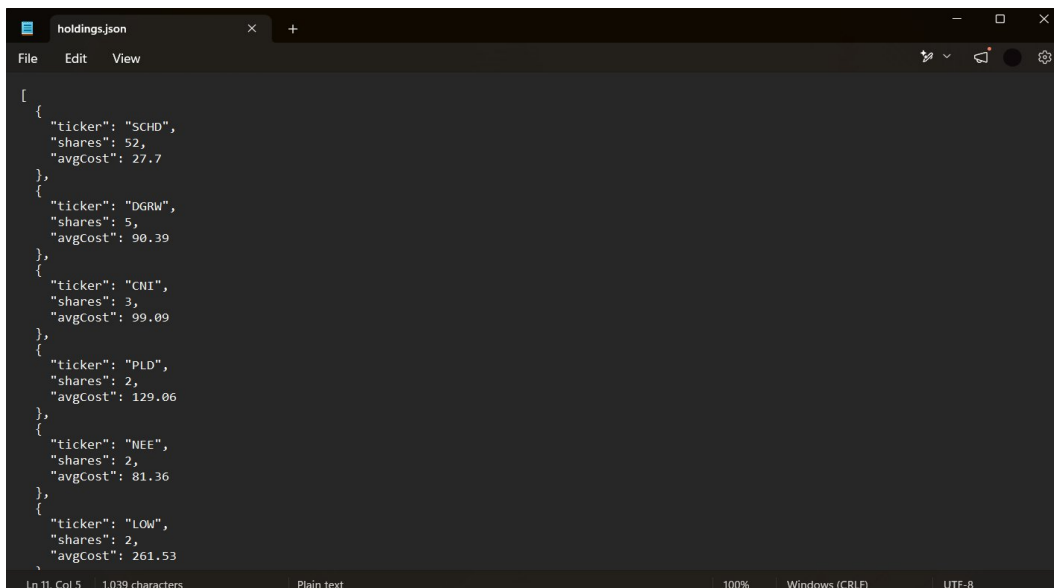
Tell the app what stocks you own.

The app reads your portfolio from a file called `holdings.json`. You need to create this file from the example that comes with the app.

1. Open the app folder.
2. Find the file named `holdings.example.json`
3. Right-click on it → Copy.
4. Right-click on an empty area in the folder → Paste.
5. Right-click the copy → Rename → type exactly:

```
holdings.json
```

6. Right-click on `holdings.json` → Open with → Notepad.



```
[
  {
    "ticker": "SCHD",
    "shares": 52,
    "avgCost": 27.7
  },
  {
    "ticker": "DGRW",
    "shares": 5,
    "avgCost": 90.39
  },
  {
    "ticker": "CNI",
    "shares": 3,
    "avgCost": 99.09
  },
  {
    "ticker": "PLD",
    "shares": 2,
    "avgCost": 129.06
  },
  {
    "ticker": "NEE",
    "shares": 2,
    "avgCost": 81.36
  },
  {
    "ticker": "LOW",
    "shares": 2,
    "avgCost": 261.53
  }
]
```

↑ The `holdings.json` file open in Notepad — replace the example entries with your own stocks

7. Replace the example entries with your actual stocks:

```
[ {"ticker": "SCHD", "shares": 52, "avgCost": 27.70},
  {"ticker": "AVGO", "shares": 2, "avgCost": 185.00} ]
```

ticker = stock symbol | shares = number of shares | avgCost = average purchase price in USD

✓ Make sure every line except the last stock entry has a comma at the end.

8. Press Ctrl + S to save. Close Notepad.

Step 6

Add an Alpha Vantage API Key (Optional)

Unlocks up to 20 years of financial history. The app works fine without it.

Without the key, the app pulls data from Yahoo Finance for free — prices, dividends, and basic financials. The key adds the Stock Deep-Dive tab with up to 20 years of detailed financial history.

If you want to skip this for now, go directly to Step 7.

How to get a free key:

1. Go to: alphavantage.co → click Get Free API Key
2. Fill in your name and email. No credit card needed.
3. You will receive a key — a string of letters and numbers.

How to add it to the app:

1. In the app folder, find the file `.env.example`

■ If you cannot see it: File Explorer → View → tick Hidden items.
2. Right-click → Copy → Paste → rename the copy to exactly:

`.env`
3. Right-click `.env` → Open with → Notepad.
4. Replace `your_key_here` with your actual key and save.

Step 7

Set Your Income Goal (Optional)

Set a passive income target to track your progress.

The Goals tab lets you set an annual passive income target and shows your progress toward it.

1. Find `goal.example.json` in the app folder.
2. Copy it → rename the copy to `goal.json`
3. Open with Notepad → change 24000 to your own target in USD → save.

Step 8

Run the App

One command, then open your browser.

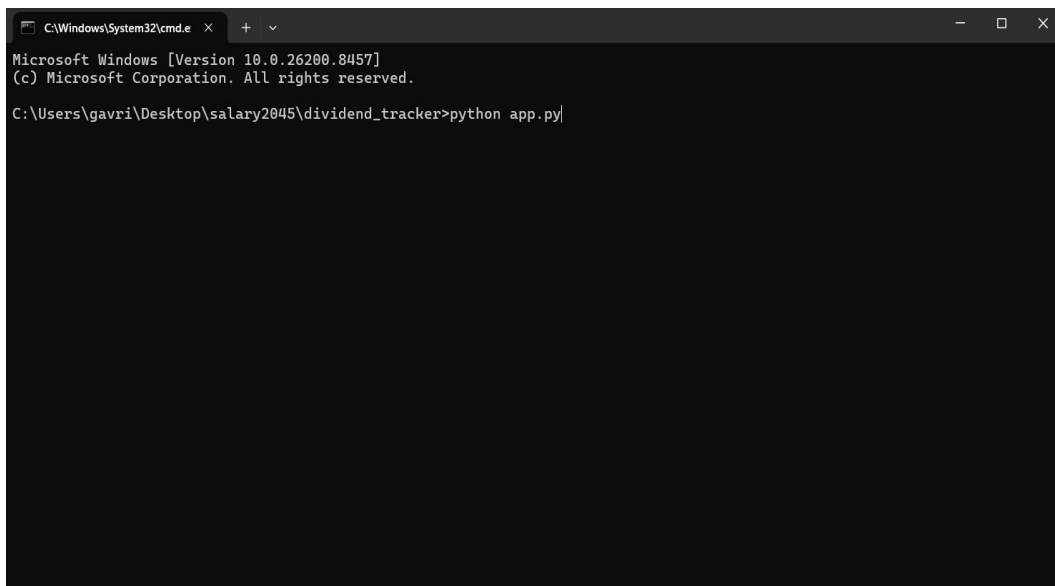
Option A — The easy way (double-click):

The app folder contains a file called Start Salary2045.bat — double-click it. It will start the app and open your browser automatically.

Option B — Via the terminal:

1. Open the terminal inside the app folder (same as Step 3).
2. Type the following and press Enter:

```
python app.py
```



↑ Type python app.py and press Enter

```
C:\Windows\System32\cmd.exe
Microsoft Windows [Version 10.0.26200.8457]
(c) Microsoft Corporation. All rights reserved.

C:\Users\gavri\Desktop\salary2045\dividend_tracker>python app.py

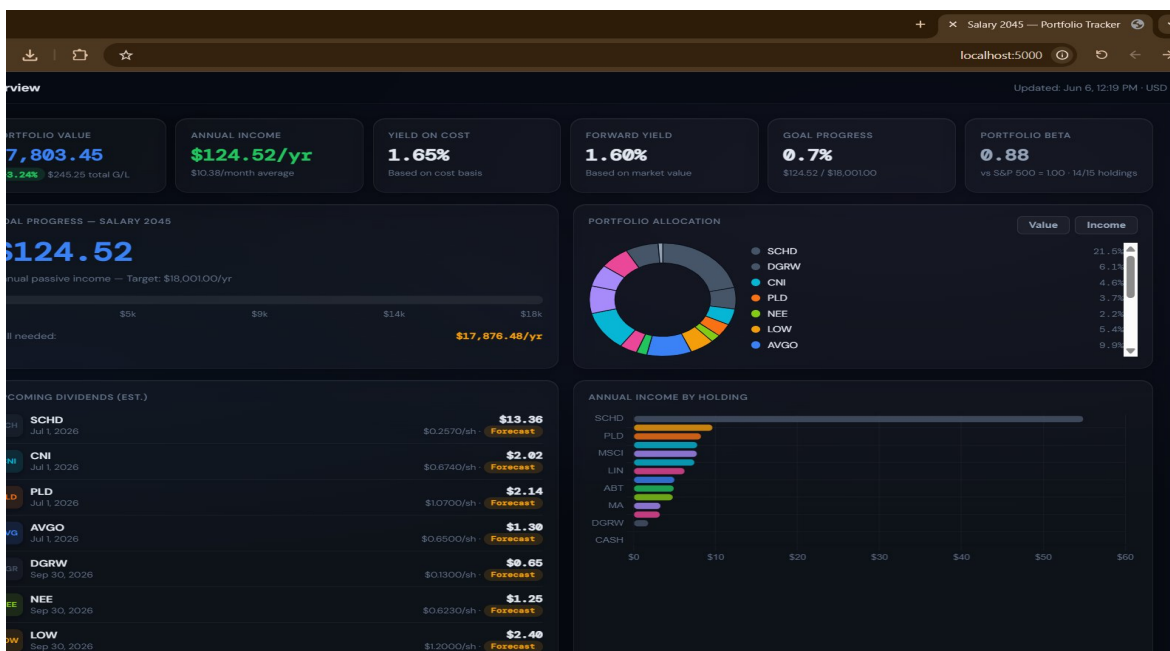
Salary 2045 Tracker running at http://localhost:5000

* Serving Flask app 'app'
* Debug mode: off
WARNING: This is a development server. Do not use it in a production deployment. Use a production WSGI server instead.
* Running on all addresses (0.0.0.0)
* Running on http://127.0.0.1:5000
* Running on http://172.20.10.3:5000
Press CTRL+C to quit
```

↑ When you see 'Running on http://localhost:5000' — the app is ready. The red WARNING is normal, not an error.

3. Open your browser and go to:

<http://localhost:5000>



↑ The Salary 2045 app running in your browser

✓ The app is running. You are done.

To stop the app: click inside the terminal window and press Ctrl + C.

Troubleshooting

Solutions to the most common problems.

Browser shows "This site can't be reached"

The app is not running. Open the terminal, run `python app.py` and try again.

Terminal shows "ModuleNotFoundError"

Run the pip install command from Step 4 again. Make sure the terminal is open inside the correct folder.

Terminal shows "python is not recognized"

Uninstall Python via Start → Add or remove programs, reinstall from python.org/downloads, and tick Add Python to PATH.

Cannot see the file `.env.example`

File Explorer → View → tick Hidden items.

Yellow [notice] message after pip install

This is not an error. It just means there is a newer version of pip available. You can ignore it.